



Weekly Wonders

Teacher Reference Guide

This document lists every clue, answer, and set of facts currently in the Weekly Wonders app, so you can plan ahead — decide which wonder to assign as homework, and know exactly what to check off in the unlock screen once it's time to reveal the answer.

Currently contains 100 Weekly Wonders (#1–#100).

Quick Reference

#	Answer / Topic	Clue given to students
1	Your Eyes	This remains the same size throughout our lifetime.
2	Applesauce	This is the first food to be eaten in space.
3	Isaac Newton	Albert Einstein said this was the smartest person who ever lived.
4	Cycling	This is one of the best pastimes for people who want to reduce the risk of having heart disease or a stroke.
5	The Common Cold	Over the centuries and around the world, lizard soup, blood-letting, leeches, turnips, plum pickle and the familiar chicken soup have all been used to try to heal this.
6	Rainbows	You are more likely to see this in the Summer than the Winter.
7	Snails	This invertebrate was once displayed in a museum thought to be dead until it started moving several years later.
8	M&Ms	This snack was invented because chocolate melted too fast in the sun.
9	Horseshoe Crabs	This creature has blue blood!
10	Niagara Falls	The world's first hydroelectric power plant was created here.
11	Great Wall of China	This wonder can be seen from space (with binoculars) if the conditions are right.
12	Light	This travels at about 300,000 km's per second.

#	Answer / Topic	Clue given to students
13	Sir Michael Jones	This famous rugby player was knighted for their services to the Pacific community and youth.
14	Butterflies	There are approximately 20,000 known species of these worldwide.
15	Leaning Tower of Pisa	You need to climb 251 steps to get to the top.
16	Pizza	Americans eat 350 pieces of this every second.
17	Daffodils	Extracts from these have been used to treat Alzheimer's disease.
18	Kangaroo Rat	Known for their incredible jumping ability, water conservation skills, and nocturnal habits.
19	Wombats	This animal has cube-shaped poop!
20	Queenstown	Movies such as Mission Impossible Fallout, Lord of the Rings, The Lion Witch and the Wardrobe, Prince Caspian, and Wolverine were filmed here.
21	Scotland	This country has a waterfall that is 3 times the height of Niagara Falls.
22	Bananas	Some cultures (most notably Japan) use the fiber from this food plant to make fabric and sometimes even paper.
23	Pencil	This can be used underwater, in space, and upside down.
24	Slinky	This toy was inspired by a walking factory spring.
25	Tardigrades (Water Bears)	This tiny animal can survive freezing, heat, and even space!
26	Axolotls	This animal can regrow part of its brain!
27	Frigatebird	This bird can sleep while flying!
28	Snoopy (Peanuts)	This was inspired by an adopted black and white dog called Spike.
29	Carrots	Too many of these can make your skin turn yellow. The condition is also named after these.
30	Sand	In India, illegal mining of this item is the country's largest organized criminal activity. The black market for it is estimated to be worth 200-300 billion dollars per year.
31	Michael Jordan	He was the first billionaire athlete.

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32	Anna Pavlova	A dessert was named in honor of this famous dancer.
33	Kookaburra	This bird got its common name from the loud territorial sound that it makes. The calls are often mistaken for many different animals, such as donkeys or monkeys.
34	Ayers Rock (Uluru)	Climbing of this rock is prohibited, but Prince Charles and Princess Diana still climbed it.
35	Golf	This was banned 3 times in Scotland because it interfered with military training.
36	Hair	People lose on average about 50-150 of these a day. In general, females lose more than males.
37	Rome	This city has more fountains than any other city on the planet.
38	Gum	This thing has its own national day on September 30th. National — day.
39	Ice Cream	New Zealand eats the most of this per capita (person) in the world.
40	Michelangelo	Despite being one of the wealthiest artists of his time, he lived like a hermit and rarely met people.
41	Golden Eagle	This animal can reach speeds of up to 193 kms per hour.
42	Archery	This is one of the oldest sports in the world, and the first known usage of it was in 2340 BC by the Babylonians.
43	Horse	The standard measurement used to measure the height of this animal is 'hands'.
44	Sunglasses	In America, these get lost, sat on, or broken every 14 minutes. That means over 37,500 every year.
45	The Bible	This is the most stolen book in the world. It's regularly taken from hotels, hospitals, and book stores.
46	Pickling (Pickles)	Ancient Egyptians and Mesopotamians were known to do this to their food to preserve it through long journeys and harsh seasons.
47	Lionel Messi	This person is sometimes nicknamed 'La Pulga'

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		('The Flea') because of their quick and amazing movements.
48	China	In ancient times, soldiers in this country sometimes wore armour made from paper.
49	Violin	Over 75 different pieces of wood are used to build a modern version of one of these.
50	Lightning	These can reach a temperature of almost 30,000 degrees Celsius — 5 times hotter than the surface of the sun.
51	Toothbrush	The first of these were sticks used by ancient Egyptians, Greeks, Romans, and Indians — frayed on one end to make them work more effectively.
52	Stars	A person with good eyesight can probably see between 2000-2500 of these at a time.
53	Captain Cook	His boat 'The Endeavour' almost sank when he hit sharp coral in the Great Barrier Reef, Australia.
54	Eric Liddell	This person refused to participate in his main event at the Olympics because the qualifying round was on a Sunday and he was a devout Christian.
55	Samoa	Because this country is the closest to the west side of the International Date Line, it is the first to see the new day — and therefore the first to celebrate the new year.
56	Christchurch	This place is geographically unique because it is one of only 8 cities that have a near-exact antipodal city.
57	Wheelchair	In 2013, Aaron 'Wheelz' Fotheringham became the first person to successfully complete a backflip using one of these.
58	Potatoes	Vincent Van Gogh painted four still-life paintings featuring these — one was called 'The (this) Eaters'.
59	The Amazon Rainforest	The South American one of these is so big that if it were a country, it would be the ninth biggest in the world.
60	LEGO	Laid end to end, the number of these sold in a year would reach more than five times around

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		the world.
61	Sharks	These don't have bones — their skeletons are made of cartilage, the same soft, flexible stuff your ears and the tip of your nose are made of.
62	Hats	Between 1784 and 1811, these were taxed in the UK. If you sold them you needed a special licence, and buyers had to pay a tax too — a way for the government to get money from the rich.
63	Cricket	This sport is so popular that it's considered the second most-loved sport in the world, enjoyed by more than 2.5 billion fans in 180 countries.
64	Showers	The world record for the longest of these goes to Kevin 'Catfish' McCarthy, who spent 340 hours and 40 minutes in one.
65	Pine Trees (Christmas Trees)	In the right environment, these are known to live 100 years on average and can grow up to 46 metres high.
66	Perfume	This doesn't have an expiry date, but it will change over time — which is why you should use it within the first three years.
67	Weeds	During World War II, a type of this plant fiber was used to stuff life jackets — about six times more buoyant than cork.
68	Giraffes	They have a highly specialized cardiovascular system to manage blood flow to their brains. Their hearts are incredibly strong and large — about 0.6 metres long and weighing around 11 kgs.
69	Christmas Lights	A study by the University of Pennsylvania found that neighborhoods with more of these had lower crime rates.
70	Octopuses	This sea creature has three hearts and blue blood.
71	Popcorn	This snack can pop up to 3 feet into the air.
72	Quicksand	You actually can't fully sink in this, no matter what the movies show.
73	Volcanoes	Some of these shoot out strands of glass instead of lava.
74	Black Holes	Time moves slower the closer you get to one of

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		these.
75	Roller Coasters	The very first versions of this ride were made of ice.
76	Yo-Yos	This toy was once used as a hunting weapon.
77	Trampolines	This piece of equipment was studied to help train pilots and astronauts.
78	Skateboarding	This sport started out being called 'sidewalk surfing'.
79	Glow Worms	Despite the name, this creature isn't actually a worm.
80	Venus Flytraps	This plant can count to five.
81	Electric Eels	This creature isn't actually an eel at all.
82	Mount Everest	This mountain grows a few millimeters taller every single year.
83	Sloths	This animal can hold its breath longer than a dolphin.
84	Koalas	This animal has fingerprints that are almost identical to a human's.
85	Platypuses	This animal glows under UV light.
86	Narwhals	This animal's famous 'horn' is actually a giant tooth.
87	Peacocks	Males of this bird lose their spectacular tail feathers every single year.
88	Chameleons	This animal doesn't mainly change color to hide from predators.
89	Boomerangs	Some versions of this toy are designed to never come back.
90	Fireworks	The colors in this display come from burning different metals.
91	T-Rex	This dinosaur had a bite force strong enough to crush a car.
92	Penguins	This bird proposes to its mate with a pebble.
93	Honey Bees	This insect never sleeps.
94	Marshmallows	This sweet treat was originally made from a plant

#	Answer / Topic	Clue given to students
		root.
95	Bubble Wrap	This packing material was originally invented as wallpaper.
96	Rubik's Cube	This puzzle has over 43 quintillion possible combinations.
97	Static Electricity	This invisible force can make your hair stand straight up.
98	Quokkas	This animal is often called the world's happiest animal because of its permanent smile.
99	Hiccups	Babies do this while they're still inside the womb.
100	Fireflies	This insect's light is nearly 100% efficient, wasting almost no energy as heat.

Full Details

Weekly Wonder #1 — Your Eyes

Clue: *This remains the same size throughout our lifetime.*

Answer: Your Eyes

Fact 1: The human eye blinks an average of 4,200,000 times a year. This means if you were given 10 cents for every time you blinked you would make \$420,000 annually.

Fact 2: Your eye is the fastest muscle in your body. Hence, the phrase: “In the blink of an eye.”

Fact 3: Your iris has 256 unique characteristics, while your fingerprint only has 40.

Weekly Wonder #2 — Applesauce

Clue: *This is the first food to be eaten in space.*

Answer: Applesauce

Fact 1: Since it is high in pectin, apple sauce is a homemade remedy for children with diarrhea or stomach problems.

Fact 2: Why do apples float? It's because they're 25 percent air, giving us the ability to bob for apples in a barrel of water.

Fact 3: The largest apple peel was created by Kathy Wafler from New York in 1976. The prize-winning peel was 52.5m long.

Weekly Wonder #3 — Isaac Newton

Clue: *Albert Einstein said this was the smartest person who ever lived.*

Answer: Isaac Newton

Fact 1: During the Great Plague, Isaac Newton spent two years in study and isolation at his home developing his theories on calculus, gravity, and the laws of motion.

Fact 2: His mother wanted him to be a farmer so took him out of school. He didn't enjoy it so was soon back at school again.

Fact 3: In Isaac's time the calendar was different, and even though by today's calendar he was born in January, by that time's calendar he was considered to be born on Christmas Day.

Weekly Wonder #4 — Cycling

Clue: *This is one of the best pastimes for people who want to reduce the risk of having heart disease or a stroke.*

Answer: Cycling

Fact 1: The same energy that is expended for walking can be used when cycling to go three times faster.

Fact 2: Bicycles save over 900 million litres of fuel every year.

Fact 3: The fastest measured speed of riding a bicycle on a flat surface is 133.75 km/h.

Weekly Wonder #5 — The Common Cold

Clue: *Over the centuries and around the world, lizard soup, blood-letting, leeches, turnips, plum pickle and the familiar chicken soup have all been used to try to heal this.*

Answer: The Common Cold

Fact 1: There are plenty of good reasons to eat vitamin C packed foods like oranges and broccoli. However, there is currently little evidence to suggest that taking this vitamin reduces your chances of getting a cold.

Fact 2: A single sneeze can spray 100,000 germs into the air, which is why you should keep 2 meters distance from a sneezing sick person.

Fact 3: Being cold or wet doesn't cause colds or make you more likely to get sick.

Weekly Wonder #6 — Rainbows

Clue: *You are more likely to see this in the Summer than the Winter.*

Answer: Rainbows

Fact 1: You are less likely to see a rainbow in the winter – but why? Because of snow! A rainbow is the result of light passing through a spectrum – in most cases, a collection of raindrops.

Fact 2: The average rainbow is observable for less than an hour. But in 2017 in Taiwan, people observed a rainbow for 8 hours and 58 minutes.

Fact 3: A double rainbow appears when light is reflected twice in a raindrop. The secondary rainbow – which will be a little bit higher and fainter in color – will actually have its colors reversed.

Weekly Wonder #7 — Snails

Clue: *This invertebrate was once displayed in a museum thought to be dead until it started moving several years later.*

Answer: Snails

Fact 1: Certain land snails can sleep for up to three years in hibernation, but generally, snails will sleep on and off in between periods of 13 to 15 hours. Afterwards, they experience a sudden jolt of energy for the next 30 hours, where they get all their snail chores done!

Fact 2: The speed of snails is around 12-20 mm per second. If they moved without stopping, it would take more than a week to complete 1 kilometer.

Fact 3: The mucus of the garden snail is used to treat wrinkles, spots, and scars on the skin.

Weekly Wonder #8 — M&Ms

Clue: *This snack was invented because chocolate melted too fast in the sun.*

Answer: M&Ms

Fact 1: M&Ms were made for soldiers in WWII so chocolate wouldn't melt in their hands.

Fact 2: The "M" stands for the names Mars and Murrie.

Fact 3: They were originally only made in the color brown.

Weekly Wonder #9 — Horseshoe Crabs

Clue: *This creature has blue blood!*

Answer: Horseshoe Crabs

Fact 1: Horseshoe crabs have blue blood because it contains copper instead of iron.

Fact 2: Their blood is used to test medicine safety — it's super sensitive to bacteria.

Fact 3: They have strong shells and live in muddy ocean shores.

Weekly Wonder #10 — Niagara Falls

Clue: *The world's first hydroelectric power plant was created here.*

Answer: **Niagara Falls**

Fact 1: More than 8 million visitors explore Niagara Falls State Park annually, coming from all over the world.

Fact 2: The first person to go over Niagara Falls in a barrel was 63-year-old schoolteacher Annie Edson Taylor — she suffered only a concussion and a minor cut on her head.

Fact 3: Fish do plunge over the Falls, and it's estimated that almost all of them survive, thanks to their ability to flow with the water. Sometimes, however, they are a bit “stunned” after making the journey.

Weekly Wonder #11 — Great Wall of China

Clue: *This wonder can be seen from space (with binoculars) if the conditions are right.*

Answer: **Great Wall of China**

Fact 1: Many workers lost their lives during the construction of the wall.

Fact 2: It stretches across Northern China and covers over 21,000 kms.

Fact 3: Construction started over 2000 years ago in the 7th century BC.

Weekly Wonder #12 — Light

Clue: *This travels at about 300,000 km's per second.*

Answer: **Light**

Fact 1: The color of an object that we see is actually the color of the light that it reflects — e.g. a red apple appears red because it reflects red light and absorbs all other colors.

Fact 2: The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, are caused by charged particles from the sun colliding with particles in the Earth's atmosphere, creating a beautiful display of light in the sky.

Fact 3: Different animals can see different ranges of light. For example, some birds can see ultraviolet light, which humans can't see.

Weekly Wonder #13 — Sir Michael Jones

Clue: *This famous rugby player was knighted for their services to the Pacific community and youth.*

Answer: **Sir Michael Jones**

Fact 1: He was known for his Christian beliefs, which meant he chose not to play on Sundays.

Fact 2: He played once for Western Samoa and 55 times for New Zealand.

Fact 3: He was part of the All Black team that won the very first Rugby World Cup in 1987.

Weekly Wonder #14 — Butterflies

Clue: *There are approximately 20,000 known species of these worldwide.*

Answer: **Butterflies**

Fact 1: Some butterflies have a wingspan of 1.3 cms whilst another, named ‘Queen Alexandra’s’, has a wingspan of 30cm.

Fact 2: Monarch butterfly migrations can cover up to 4,800 kms (more than twice the length of NZ).

Fact 3: Fastest butterflies: Convolvulus hawk-moth = 100 km/hr, Skipper = 60 km/hr, Hawk Moth (general) = 50 km/hr.

Weekly Wonder #15 — Leaning Tower of Pisa

Clue: *You need to climb 251 steps to get to the top.*

Answer: Leaning Tower of Pisa

Fact 1: It was not originally leaning when it was built.

Fact 2: Pisa survived 4 earthquakes.

Fact 3: It took almost 2 centuries to build because of wars and battles that interrupted its construction.

Weekly Wonder #16 — Pizza

Clue: *Americans eat 350 pieces of this every second.*

Answer: Pizza

Fact 1: Luis XIII in Salerno, Italy has the world's most expensive pizza at \$12,000! It includes three types of caviar, lobster, bufala mozzarella cheese, and grains of pink Australian sea salt.

Fact 2: At the World Pizza Championships, dough-spinning has its own professional-level sporting event, with five competitive events: Freestyle Acrobatic Dough Tossing, Fastest Dough, Largest Dough Stretch, Fastest Pizza Box Folding, and the Pizza Triathlon.

Fact 3: The Hawaiian pizza was invented in Canada. With only three toppings available — mushroom, bacon, or pepperoni — Sam Panopoulos decided to throw a can of pineapple on his pizza.

Weekly Wonder #17 — Daffodils

Clue: *Extracts from these have been used to treat Alzheimer's disease.*

Answer: Daffodils

Fact 1: The bulbs can be poisonous to animals. Squirrels won't eat daffodils because of this, and you should make sure you plant daffodil bulbs where cats and dogs can't get them.

Fact 2: Don't mix them with other flowers in a vase — daffodils release latex from their stems once cut, which can shorten the life of other flowers.

Fact 3: Daffodils are one of the first signs of Spring and are also strongly associated with Easter because of this.

Weekly Wonder #18 — Kangaroo Rat

Clue: *Known for their incredible jumping ability, water conservation skills, and nocturnal habits.*

Answer: Kangaroo Rat

Fact 1: The kangaroo rat gets all its water from seeds, and never needs to drink!

Fact 2: Their powerful hind legs allow them to leap up to 2.7 meters in one bound, helping them escape predators.

Fact 3: They have fur-lined food storage pouches in their cheeks to collect and transport seeds and other food items.

Weekly Wonder #19 — Wombats

Clue: *This animal has cube-shaped poop!*

Answer: Wombats

Fact 1: Wombats use cube-shaped poop to mark territory — it doesn't roll away!

Fact 2: Their butt is their main form of defence — they can crush a predator's skull with their behind.

Fact 3: They have strong back ends to block tunnels from predators.

Weekly Wonder #20 — Queenstown

Clue: *Movies such as Mission Impossible Fallout, Lord of the Rings, The Lion Witch and the Wardrobe, Prince Caspian, and Wolverine were filmed here.*

Answer: Queenstown

Fact 1: Lonely Planet made some statistics saying Lake Wakatipu has some of the cleanest water in the world.

Fact 2: There are still opportunities to make money gold prospecting, as gold is still found on the Shotover River.

Fact 3: Queenstown has the 4th busiest airport in New Zealand, which is impressive considering it only has the 27th largest urban population.

Weekly Wonder #21 — Scotland

Clue: *This country has a waterfall that is 3 times the height of Niagara Falls.*

Answer: Scotland

Fact 1: The highest proportion of redheads in the world are in Scotland.

Fact 2: The official animal of Scotland is the unicorn, and according to legend it is considered one of the only animals powerful enough to defeat formidable opponents, such as elephants, in battle.

Fact 3: The raincoat was invented in Scotland by a man named Charles Macintosh, who was born in Glasgow.

Weekly Wonder #22 — Bananas

Clue: *Some cultures (most notably Japan) use the fiber from this food plant to make fabric and sometimes even paper.*

Answer: Bananas

Fact 1: Bananas have around 30,000 genes — that's more than humans!

Fact 2: Bananas are naturally slightly radioactive (thanks to their potassium content) — but the level of radiation is not high enough to cause harm.

Fact 3: If you rub the inside of a banana peel on a scrape or burn, it will help the pain go away, keep the swelling down, and keep the wound from getting infected.

Weekly Wonder #23 — Pencil

Clue: *This can be used underwater, in space, and upside down.*

Answer: Pencil

Fact 1: On average a pencil can be sharpened 17 times, draw a line 56 kms long, and can write approximately 45,000 words.

Fact 2: The most expensive pencil in the world is the Graf von Faber-Castell Perfect Pencil. It's crafted from 240-year-old olive wood and 18-karat white gold and costs \$12,800.

Fact 3: An average size tree will make approximately 300,000 pencils.

Weekly Wonder #24 — Slinky

Clue: *This toy was inspired by a walking factory spring.*

Answer: Slinky

Fact 1: The Slinky was invented when a spring fell off a desk and “walked.” It was originally being created as a part of a ship.

Fact 2: During the Vietnam War, soldiers used Slinkys as mobile antennas.

Fact 3: The first Slinky demonstration at Gimbel’s Department Store in Philadelphia in 1945 sold all 400 units in 90 minutes.

Weekly Wonder #25 — Tardigrades (Water Bears)

Clue: *This tiny animal can survive freezing, heat, and even space!*

Answer: Tardigrades (Water Bears)

Fact 1: Tardigrades (water bears) curl up into a dry ball called a ‘tun.’

Fact 2: They’ve survived in space and came back alive!

Fact 3: They’re so small you need a microscope to see them.

Weekly Wonder #26 — Axolotls

Clue: *This animal can regrow part of its brain!*

Answer: Axolotls

Fact 1: Axolotls can regrow body parts like tails and limbs.

Fact 2: They breathe through gills and lungs!

Fact 3: They’re known as the ‘smiling salamander.’

Weekly Wonder #27 — Frigatebird

Clue: *This bird can sleep while flying!*

Answer: Frigatebird

Fact 1: Frigatebirds nap by shutting down half their brain at a time.

Fact 2: They can fly for weeks without stopping.

Fact 3: Magnificent frigatebirds practice kleptoparasitism — stealing food (fish and squid) from other seabirds, like blue-footed boobies.

Weekly Wonder #28 — Snoopy (Peanuts)

Clue: *This was inspired by an adopted black and white dog called Spike.*

Answer: Snoopy (Peanuts)

Fact 1: Though we never saw the inside of Snoopy’s doghouse in the comic strip, it was revealed over the years that it held a lot of personal possessions, including records, books, an original Vincent van Gogh painting, and a pool table.

Fact 2: In 2015, Snoopy received a coveted star on the Walk of Fame. Appropriately, it’s located right next to Charles Schulz’s.

Fact 3: Snoopy has an active imagination. Sometimes he pretends to be college student Joe Cool, other times he thinks he’s Flying Ace, a World War I pilot.

Weekly Wonder #29 — Carrots

Clue: *Too many of these can make your skin turn yellow. The condition is also named after these.*

Answer: Carrots

Fact 1: The most common carrots are orange, but they also come in white, yellow, and purple colors.

Fact 2: Baby carrots are just regular carrots that have been pre-shaped, cut, and peeled to look appealing.

Fact 3: Many say that raw vegetables are better for you than cooked ones, but the opposite is true for carrots.

Weekly Wonder #30 — Sand

Clue: *In India, illegal mining of this item is the country's largest organized criminal activity. The black market for it is estimated to be worth 200-300 billion dollars per year.*

Answer: Sand

Fact 1: If you put grains under a microscope you will see different shapes, colors, and even tiny fossils.

Fact 2: In only a few sand dunes around the world there are singing sand dunes. They make weird, loud humming noises when the sand moves.

Fact 3: Not all sand is yellow or white! It can be pink (Bahamas — from crushed shells), green (Hawai'i — from olivine crystals), black (Iceland — from volcanic rock), or red (Australia — from iron-rich sandstone).

Weekly Wonder #31 — Michael Jordan

Clue: *He was the first billionaire athlete.*

Answer: Michael Jordan

Fact 1: Jordan tried to get into the varsity basketball team. At the time he was 180.3 cm tall and quite skinny, so he wasn't allowed on the team.

Fact 2: Michael Jordan retired in 1993 from the Chicago Bulls after the death of his father, who was very close to him.

Fact 3: Jordan has a fear of water from a tragic incident during his childhood — he saw a good friend drown, and shortly after, he almost drowned himself while at baseball camp.

Weekly Wonder #32 — Anna Pavlova

Clue: *A dessert was named in honor of this famous dancer.*

Answer: Anna Pavlova

Fact 1: Anna gave over four thousand ballet performances during the years between 1913 and 1930.

Fact 2: She had no children of her own, but following the devastation of World War I, she established a home for Russian orphans.

Fact 3: Worn out by touring and the stress of performing, she died of pneumonia in 1931 at the age of 51.

Weekly Wonder #33 — Kookaburra

Clue: *This bird got its common name from the loud territorial sound that it makes. The calls are often mistaken for many different animals, such as donkeys or monkeys.*

Answer: Kookaburra

Fact 1: As kookaburras can be heard very early in the morning they are called the 'bushman's clock'.

Fact 2: The kookaburra uses its brown and white feathers to blend into its environment, making it harder for both prey and predators to spot.

Fact 3: Baby kookaburras are born naked and blind, but they have a very sharp hook at the end of their beak. The first chick that hatches may turn on their younger siblings, bite them, or even kill them if there isn't enough food.

Weekly Wonder #34 — Ayers Rock (Uluru)

Clue: *Climbing of this rock is prohibited, but Prince Charles and Princess Diana still climbed it.*

Answer: Ayers Rock (Uluru)

Fact 1: It varies from year to year, but Uluru receives around 300 millimetres of rain on average each year. The rain creates waterfalls and brings new life to the rock and surrounding desert.

Fact 2: Towering 348 metres above the surrounding plain, Uluru is taller than the Eiffel Tower in Paris, the Chrysler Building in New York, and the Great Pyramid of Giza.

Fact 3: Uluru is 3.6 km long and 1.9 km wide, with a total circumference of 9.4 km. It takes about 3½ hours to walk around the base.

Weekly Wonder #35 — Golf

Clue: *This was banned 3 times in Scotland because it interfered with military training.*

Answer: Golf

Fact 1: Tiger Woods took an interest in golf at only six months old, and his father started teaching him at two years old. He got his first hole in one at 8 years old.

Fact 2: Early golf balls were made of leather and feathers. Manufacturers would wet the feathers to make them stick, then wrap them around the leather.

Fact 3: The golf tee wasn't created until the 1920s. Before that, golfers would use mounds of sand to elevate their golf balls for the opening shot.

Weekly Wonder #36 — Hair

Clue: *People lose on average about 50-150 of these a day. In general, females lose more than males.*

Answer: Hair

Fact 1: A single strand of hair can support up to 3 kgs of weight. That means a whole head of hair can support up to 2000 kgs!

Fact 2: About 95% of the total skin area is covered in hair. Who knew you were so, well, hairy.

Fact 3: Someone purchased a lock of Elvis' hair at an auction for \$15,000.

Weekly Wonder #37 — Rome

Clue: *This city has more fountains than any other city on the planet.*

Answer: Rome

Fact 1: Harming cats is punishable by Roman law. They can stay where they want and you cannot move them.

Fact 2: A special light show happens at the Pantheon every year to celebrate Rome's birthday.

Fact 3: Coins thrown into Trevi fountain add up to over 1 million euros a year.

Weekly Wonder #38 — Gum

Clue: *This thing has its own national day on September 30th. National — day.*

Answer: Gum

Fact 1: The record for the most gum chewed at a time is 250 pieces.

Fact 2: Regular chewing gum is made of plastic — ‘polyethylene’, which is also used to make tires and glue.

Fact 3: Iran chews the most gum in the world. Shop keepers will give gum instead of change if they don't have enough.

Weekly Wonder #39 — Ice Cream

Clue: *New Zealand eats the most of this per capita (person) in the world.*

Answer: Ice Cream

Fact 1: Many people think this was invented in Italy because of Gelato, but it was actually invented in China.

Fact 2: Japan has some of the most interesting flavors of ice cream, such as basil, eggplant, oyster, eel, beef tongue, coal, and Indian curry.

Fact 3: The average number of licks to finish a scoop of ice cream is 50.

Weekly Wonder #40 — Michelangelo

Clue: *Despite being one of the wealthiest artists of his time, he lived like a hermit and rarely met people.*

Answer: Michelangelo

Fact 1: His famous statue ‘David’ was made from a discarded block of marble.

Fact 2: When he was young, his nose was broken by a jealous rival — he was punched so hard he had the damage for the rest of his life.

Fact 3: Many of his works were created using his own likeness.

Weekly Wonder #41 — Golden Eagle

Clue: *This animal can reach speeds of up to 193 kms per hour.*

Answer: Golden Eagle

Fact 1: The Golden Eagle can swim if it is totally necessary.

Fact 2: In winter and early spring they defend their territories with a ‘sky dance’.

Fact 3: Parents use their bodies to insulate chicks in extreme temperatures.

Weekly Wonder #42 — Archery

Clue: *This is one of the oldest sports in the world, and the first known usage of it was in 2340 BC by the Babylonians.*

Answer: Archery

Fact 1: Olympic archers used to shoot at pigeons.

Fact 2: Archery has been said to be 3x safer than golf, with only 1 injury per 2000 participants. It is also safer than bowling.

Fact 3: Archery was the first sport to allow women to compete in the Olympic Games.

Weekly Wonder #43 — Horse

Clue: *The standard measurement used to measure the height of this animal is ‘hands’.*

Answer: Horse

Fact 1: Because of the one-way mode of their digestive tract, horses cannot burp.

Fact 2: You can estimate a horse's age by its teeth, although if it's old and its teeth are bad it will need dental work done.

Fact 3: Most Arabic breeds of horses have fewer bones than other breeds — in their tail, vertebrae, and ribs.

Weekly Wonder #44 — Sunglasses

Clue: *In America, these get lost, sat on, or broken every 14 minutes. That means over 37,500 every year.*

Answer: Sunglasses

Fact 1: Only 25% of sunglasses actually protect your eyes from the sun's harmful rays. The other 75% are only useful as a fashion accessory.

Fact 2: Different color lenses were developed by James Ayscough, in the hope of resolving color blindness.

Fact 3: They were invented 2000 years ago by the Inuit. They were made from animal bone, leather, and wood, with small slits cut so only a tiny amount of light could get through.

Weekly Wonder #45 — The Bible

Clue: *This is the most stolen book in the world. It's regularly taken from hotels, hospitals, and book stores.*

Answer: The Bible

Fact 1: It is also the most-read book in the world, with over 100 million copies sold or donated every year.

Fact 2: The Bible has about 40 different authors and was originally written in 3 different languages: Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek.

Fact 3: It is over 600,000 words long and has about 1189 chapters — 929 in the Old Testament and 260 in the New Testament.

Weekly Wonder #46 — Pickling (Pickles)

Clue: *Ancient Egyptians and Mesopotamians were known to do this to their food to preserve it through long journeys and harsh seasons.*

Answer: Pickling (Pickles)

Fact 1: Pickles are actually cucumbers that have been brined in a solution of vinegar, water, and spices.

Fact 2: Cleopatra supposedly credited her good looks to her love of pickles, and Julius Caesar was said to have fed pickles to his troops in the belief it would make them stronger.

Fact 3: In Connecticut, legend has it that state law requires that a pickle must bounce in order to legally be called a pickle.

Weekly Wonder #47 — Lionel Messi

Clue: *This person is sometimes nicknamed 'La Pulga' ('The Flea') because of their quick and amazing movements.*

Answer: Lionel Messi

Fact 1: He had a growth deficiency growing up, but when he moved to Barcelona at 13 years old, the club paid for his growth hormone treatment.

Fact 2: Messi made his debut for Barcelona's first team in 2004, when he was only 17 years old.

Fact 3: He has scored 665 goals with his left foot, 100 with his right, and 26 with his head.

Weekly Wonder #48 — China

Clue: *In ancient times, soldiers in this country sometimes wore armour made from paper.*

Answer: China

Fact 1: Put together, all of China's railway lines could loop around the world twice.

Fact 2: Parts of China can range from 49 degrees Celsius in summer to -27 degrees in winter.

Fact 3: In 2010, a 2,400-year-old pot of soup was unearthed in Xi'an, China.

Weekly Wonder #49 — Violin

Clue: *Over 75 different pieces of wood are used to build a modern version of one of these.*

Answer: Violin

Fact 1: Playing the violin burns about 170 calories per hour — an hour of walking burns between 200-300 calories.

Fact 2: Violin strings were originally made of sheep gut (commonly known as catgut), which was stretched, dried, and twisted.

Fact 3: The world record for cycling backwards while playing a violin is 60.45 kms, set in 5 hours and 8 seconds.

Weekly Wonder #50 — Lightning

Clue: *These can reach a temperature of almost 30,000 degrees Celsius — 5 times hotter than the surface of the sun.*

Answer: Lightning

Fact 1: The flash we see travels at the speed of light, about 900,000,000 kph. The lightning itself only travels around 400,000 kph — at that speed it would take 55 minutes to reach the moon.

Fact 2: The actual width of a lightning bolt is only 2-3 cms, whereas its length averages 3-5 kms.

Fact 3: When lightning strikes sand or sandy soil, it fuses the grains together to create a small glass-like tube known as fulgurite.

Weekly Wonder #51 — Toothbrush

Clue: *The first of these were sticks used by ancient Egyptians, Greeks, Romans, and Indians — frayed on one end to make them work more effectively.*

Answer: Toothbrush

Fact 1: Until the early 1900s, toothbrush bristles were made from Siberian hog hair, until the Miracle Tuft soft-bristled toothbrush was invented.

Fact 2: One in ten people admit that they regularly forget to brush their teeth.

Fact 3: Dentists recommend keeping your toothbrush at least 2 meters away from the toilet, to prevent the spread of airborne bacteria when flushing.

Weekly Wonder #52 — Stars

Clue: *A person with good eyesight can probably see between 2000-2500 of these at a time.*

Answer: Stars

Fact 1: Usually red means hot and blue means cold, but stars are the opposite — red stars are cooler and blue stars are hotter.

Fact 2: On a good night you can see 17,000,000,000,000,000 miles — that's 17 quadrillion miles to the bright star Deneb.

Fact 3: Every star you can see in our night sky is bigger than our sun. Only a few faint stars are about the same size as the sun.

Weekly Wonder #53 — Captain Cook

Clue: *His boat 'The Endeavour' almost sank when he hit sharp coral in the Great Barrier Reef, Australia.*

Answer: Captain Cook

Fact 1: Cook was famous for his mapmaking, and was the first European to define the outline of New Zealand.

Fact 2: NASA named two of their space shuttles after Cook's ships, HMS Enterprise and Endeavour. Astronauts also wore special medals to honor Cook.

Fact 3: He was killed in Hawaii by local natives — beaten with clubs, and then stabbed in the back. He was later given a king's burial.

Weekly Wonder #54 — Eric Liddell

Clue: *This person refused to participate in his main event at the Olympics because the qualifying round was on a Sunday and he was a devout Christian.*

Answer: Eric Liddell

Fact 1: He was born in China to Scottish parents who were missionaries there.

Fact 2: In 1943, during WW2, he was imprisoned in Weihsien internment camp, where he organised games for children, who called him 'Uncle Eric'.

Fact 3: He was a gifted athlete, excelling at both running and rugby. He won an Olympic gold medal in the 400m — which wasn't even his strongest event.

Weekly Wonder #55 — Samoa

Clue: *Because this country is the closest to the west side of the International Date Line, it is the first to see the new day — and therefore the first to celebrate the new year.*

Answer: Samoa

Fact 1: Samoa was known as Western Samoa up until 1997 — that's why the currency 'Samoa Tala' is sometimes referred to as 'WST'.

Fact 2: Samoans often sit on a mat on the floor with their legs crossed beneath them, with the lavalava covering their toes — it's considered rude to point your toes at someone.

Fact 3: There is a special day in October called 'White Sunday'. Children are celebrated on this day, made their favorite foods, and given special gifts.

Weekly Wonder #56 — Christchurch

Clue: *This place is geographically unique because it is one of only 8 cities that have a near-exact antipodal city.*

Answer: Christchurch

Fact 1: It's believed the Christchurch area was first settled in 1250 by tribes hunting the now-extinct moa.

Fact 2: Canterbury Pilgrims had goals of building a new city around a cathedral and college, like Christ Church, Oxford in England — hence the name Christchurch.

Fact 3: On July 31, 1856, Christchurch became the first official city in New Zealand, and it quickly grew as more European settlers arrived.

Weekly Wonder #57 — Wheelchair

Clue: *In 2013, Aaron 'Wheelz' Fotheringham became the first person to successfully complete a backflip using one of these.*

Answer: Wheelchair

Fact 1: Wheelchair basketball was invented by American World War II veterans with spinal cord injuries. The first official game was played in 1946.

Fact 2: In some countries, laws require public buildings to be wheelchair accessible — these laws have helped make public spaces more inclusive for people with disabilities.

Fact 3: The Guinness World Record for the fastest wheelchair speed is held by Heinz Frei from Switzerland, who reached 40.6 kms per hour in 2011.

Weekly Wonder #58 — Potatoes

Clue: *Vincent Van Gogh painted four still-life paintings featuring these — one was called 'The (this) Eaters'.*

Answer: Potatoes

Fact 1: Marie Antoinette liked potatoes so much that she wore their blossoms in her hair.

Fact 2: The Incas of Peru were the first to cultivate potatoes, around 8000 BC to 5000 BC.

Fact 3: Early growers discovered that just one acre of potatoes could feed ten people — much better than wheat or oats.

Weekly Wonder #59 — The Amazon Rainforest

Clue: *The South American one of these is so big that if it were a country, it would be the ninth biggest in the world.*

Answer: The Amazon Rainforest

Fact 1: It can take ten minutes for a falling raindrop to travel from the rainforest's thick canopy down to the floor.

Fact 2: A quarter of the ingredients in modern medicines come from rainforest plants.

Fact 3: A tree known as the idiot fruit grows in Australia's Daintree rainforest.

Weekly Wonder #60 — LEGO

Clue: *Laid end to end, the number of these sold in a year would reach more than five times around the world.*

Answer: LEGO

Fact 1: The world's tallest LEGO tower is 28.7m high, made from 465,000 bricks!

Fact 2: During the Christmas season, almost 28 LEGO sets are sold every second!

Fact 3: LEGO Minifigures are the world's largest population, with over 4 billion of them around the world!

Weekly Wonder #61 — Sharks

Clue: *These don't have bones — their skeletons are made of cartilage, the same soft, flexible stuff your ears and the tip of your nose are made of.*

Answer: Sharks

Fact 1: Most sharks can see well in dimly lit areas, have fantastic night vision, and can see colors.

Fact 2: Shark skin feels exactly like sandpaper because it's made up of tiny teeth-like structures called placoid scales, also known as dermal denticles.

Fact 3: When you flip a shark upside down, it goes into a trance-like state called tonic immobility.

Weekly Wonder #62 — Hats

Clue: *Between 1784 and 1811, these were taxed in the UK. If you sold them you needed a special licence, and buyers had to pay a tax too — a way for the government to get money from the rich.*

Answer: Hats

Fact 1: In Fargo, North Dakota, USA, it's illegal to wear a hat while dancing — it's also illegal to wear a hat in a place where dancing might take place.

Fact 2: There are over 100 types of hats, including bucket hats, beanies, and baseball caps — plus berets, fezzes, sombreros, cowboy hats, trilbies, and top hats!

Fact 3: The world's tallest hat is 4.8 metres tall. It was made by Odilon Ozare, who had to wear it and walk over 10 metres to get the world record!

Weekly Wonder #63 — Cricket

Clue: *This sport is so popular that it's considered the second most-loved sport in the world, enjoyed by more than 2.5 billion fans in 180 countries.*

Answer: Cricket

Fact 1: Cricket actually began in 16th century England, when children used to play it on the streets.

Fact 2: Originally, cricket wickets had two stumps and only one bail — the third stump wasn't introduced until 1775.

Fact 3: The first cricket World Cup was played by women, not men, two years before the men's tournament arrived. The inaugural Women's World Cup was held in 1973, hosted by England.

Weekly Wonder #64 — Showers

Clue: *The world record for the longest of these goes to Kevin 'Catfish' McCarthy, who spent 340 hours and 40 minutes in one.*

Answer: Showers

Fact 1: Research has shown that 42% of people pee in the shower. Another study found that 7% of people openly admit to not bathing at all — be that a shower or a bath!

Fact 2: Showers are a great money saver compared to baths, which use around 170 litres of water — a 5-minute shower uses just 70–115 litres.

Fact 3: The world's most expensive shower costs \$160,400 NZD, from a company called Sliver Tag. With an array of super geeky gadgets, the only thing this shower doesn't do is dry you afterwards!

Weekly Wonder #65 — Pine Trees (Christmas Trees)

Clue: *In the right environment, these are known to live 100 years on average and can grow up to 46 metres high.*

Answer: Pine Trees (Christmas Trees)

Fact 1: They can survive at elevations up to 13,000 metres, and are found in many mountain ranges and peaks.

Fact 2: Pines never shed their leaves — their leaves stay green all year round, and most pines have thick, scaly bark that bleeds resin.

Fact 3: Christmas trees are really pine trees — because they stay green year-round and are very hardy, they can handle all manner of decorations.

Weekly Wonder #66 — Perfume

Clue: *This doesn't have an expiry date, but it will change over time — which is why you should use it within the first three years.*

Answer: Perfume

Fact 1: You shouldn't rub your wrists together after putting on perfume — the friction creates a reaction between the fragrance and your skin's oils, which can change the scent.

Fact 2: The same scent can smell different on two different people, because perfume mixes with your skin's own chemistry.

Fact 3: Research shows perfume can alter your mood depending on its ingredients — lavender helps you relax, while a citrus-infused scent awakens your senses.

Weekly Wonder #67 — Weeds

Clue: *During World War II, a type of this plant fiber was used to stuff life jackets — about six times more buoyant than cork.*

Answer: Weeds

Fact 1: Mustard weeds are edible — there are countless varieties of mustard, and while some are more palatable than others, many can be used in salads or for making mustard.

Fact 2: In 1941, a Swiss hiker came home from a walk in the Alps with burrs all over his clothes and his dog. Looking at the burrs under a microscope, he saw they were covered with millions of tiny hooks — and went on to invent Velcro.

Fact 3: Pigweed grows 1–3 inches a day, drawing huge amounts of water and nutrients. It can reach the size of a small tree, produces up to a million seeds per plant, and has become resistant to Roundup and several other herbicides.

Weekly Wonder #68 — Giraffes

Clue: *They have a highly specialized cardiovascular system to manage blood flow to their brains. Their hearts are incredibly strong and large — about 0.6 metres long and weighing around 11 kgs.*

Answer: Giraffes

Fact 1: Giraffes primarily feed on the leaves, fruits, and flowers of woody plants, with acacia species being a favorite. Their tongues can be up to 45 cms long.

Fact 2: Giraffes usually sleep standing up, which helps them escape predators quickly if needed. They typically sleep for just a few minutes at a time, totalling about 30 minutes to 2 hours in a 24-hour period — one of the shortest sleep requirements in the animal kingdom.

Fact 3: Giraffe pregnancies last about 15 months. The female gives birth standing up, so the newborn's first experience outside the womb is almost a 2-metre drop to the ground.

Weekly Wonder #69 — Christmas Lights

Clue: *A study by the University of Pennsylvania found that neighborhoods with more of these had lower crime rates.*

Answer: Christmas Lights

Fact 1: In 1882, Edison's colleague Edward H. Johnson strung 80 colored electric lights around a Christmas tree in Edison's New York City laboratory. They were a huge success and quickly became a popular way to decorate for the holiday season.

Fact 2: Early electric Christmas lights were hand-wired with delicate glass bulbs, making them very expensive. It wasn't until the early 1900s that they became affordable for the average family.

Fact 3: In 2014, a Christmas tree in Norway was decorated with 500,000 lights. The tree was over 200 feet tall and could be seen for miles.

Weekly Wonder #70 — Octopuses

Clue: *This sea creature has three hearts and blue blood.*

Answer: Octopuses

Fact 1: Octopus blood is blue because it's copper-based instead of iron-based like ours.

Fact 2: They have no bones, so they can squeeze through any gap bigger than their beak, the only hard part of their body.

Fact 3: Octopuses can taste things just by touching them with their arms and suckers.

Weekly Wonder #71 — Popcorn

Clue: *This snack can pop up to 3 feet into the air.*

Answer: Popcorn

Fact 1: Each kernel contains a tiny bit of water, which turns to steam and builds pressure until the kernel explodes.

Fact 2: Native Americans were popping corn thousands of years before Europeans ever arrived.

Fact 3: The world's largest popcorn ball on record weighed over 9,000 kgs — heavier than an elephant.

Weekly Wonder #72 — Quicksand

Clue: *You actually can't fully sink in this, no matter what the movies show.*

Answer: Quicksand

Fact 1: Quicksand is just ordinary sand that's been saturated with water, which makes it behave like a liquid until you move.

Fact 2: Since your body is less dense than quicksand, you naturally float instead of sinking all the way — panicking and thrashing is what actually pulls people under.

Fact 3: The safest way out is to move slowly, lean back to spread your weight, and paddle toward firmer ground.

Weekly Wonder #73 — Volcanoes

Clue: *Some of these shoot out strands of glass instead of lava.*

Answer: Volcanoes

Fact 1: Certain eruptions produce thin strands of volcanic glass nicknamed 'Pele's hair', after the Hawaiian goddess of volcanoes.

Fact 2: Volcanoes exist on other planets too — Mars is home to Olympus Mons, the largest volcano in the entire solar system.

Fact 3: There are roughly 1,500 potentially active volcanoes around the world, not even counting the ones hidden underwater.

Weekly Wonder #74 — Black Holes

Clue: *Time moves slower the closer you get to one of these.*

Answer: Black Holes

Fact 1: Black holes form when massive stars collapse in on themselves at the end of their life.

Fact 2: Nothing can escape a black hole once it crosses the 'event horizon' — not even light.

Fact 3: There's a supermassive black hole sitting at the very center of our own galaxy, the Milky Way.

Weekly Wonder #75 — Roller Coasters

Clue: *The very first versions of this ride were made of ice.*

Answer: Roller Coasters

Fact 1: In 17th century Russia, people built giant ice slides and rode down them on sleds — an early ancestor of the roller coaster.

Fact 2: The first wheeled roller coaster was built in France after warmer weather made the ice slides impossible to keep running year-round.

Fact 3: The tallest roller coaster in the world today stands taller than a 45-story building.

Weekly Wonder #76 — Yo-Yos

Clue: *This toy was once used as a hunting weapon.*

Answer: Yo-Yos

Fact 1: Ancient Filipino hunters are believed to have used large yo-yo-like weapons on ropes that could be thrown and pulled back.

Fact 2: The yo-yo is one of the oldest toys in the world, with versions dating back over 2,500 years to ancient Greece.

Fact 3: The world's largest working yo-yo weighs almost 2 tonnes.

Weekly Wonder #77 — Trampolines

Clue: *This piece of equipment was studied to help train pilots and astronauts.*

Answer: Trampolines

Fact 1: Early trampolines were inspired by circus performers who used safety nets to bounce after trapeze acts.

Fact 2: NASA studied trampoline-style bouncing because it builds coordination in ways similar to moving in zero gravity.

Fact 3: Trampolining became an official Olympic sport in the year 2000.

Weekly Wonder #78 — Skateboarding

Clue: *This sport started out being called 'sidewalk surfing'.*

Answer: Skateboarding

Fact 1: Skateboarding began in California in the 1950s, when surfers wanted something to ride when the waves were flat.

Fact 2: Early skateboards were often homemade, using wooden boards with roller skate wheels bolted on.

Fact 3: Skateboarding became an official Olympic sport in 2020.

Weekly Wonder #79 — Glow Worms

Clue: *Despite the name, this creature isn't actually a worm.*

Answer: Glow Worms

Fact 1: Glow worms are really the larvae of certain beetles and flies, not true worms at all.

Fact 2: Their glow comes from a chemical reaction inside their bodies called bioluminescence.

Fact 3: They use their glow to attract prey — insects fly toward the light and get caught in sticky threads.

Weekly Wonder #80 — Venus Flytraps

Clue: *This plant can count to five.*

Answer: Venus Flytraps

Fact 1: A Venus flytrap's trap only snaps shut after something touches its trigger hairs twice within about 20 seconds — a built-in counter that stops it wasting energy on false alarms.

Fact 2: It takes several more touches after that before the trap actually starts digesting its prey.

Fact 3: Each individual trap can only close and reopen a handful of times before it stops working and falls off.

Weekly Wonder #81 — Electric Eels

Clue: *This creature isn't actually an eel at all.*

Answer: Electric Eels

Fact 1: Electric eels are more closely related to catfish and carp than to true eels.

Fact 2: They can produce a shock of up to 600 volts — enough to stun a horse.

Fact 3: They need to surface for air every so often, since they breathe partly through their mouths.

Weekly Wonder #82 — Mount Everest

Clue: *This mountain grows a few millimeters taller every single year.*

Answer: Mount Everest

Fact 1: Everest is still growing because of the ongoing collision between the Indian and Eurasian tectonic plates.

Fact 2: Its summit is so high that some planes fly below it.

Fact 3: Hundreds of climbers have died attempting to reach the top, and many remain on the mountain because it's too dangerous to bring them down.

Weekly Wonder #83 — Sloths

Clue: *This animal can hold its breath longer than a dolphin.*

Answer: Sloths

Fact 1: Sloths can slow their heart rate right down and hold their breath for up to 40 minutes underwater.

Fact 2: They only come down from the trees about once a week, usually just to go to the bathroom.

Fact 3: Algae often grows in a sloth's fur, giving it a greenish tint that helps camouflage it in the trees.

Weekly Wonder #84 — Koalas

Clue: *This animal has fingerprints that are almost identical to a human's.*

Answer: Koalas

Fact 1: Koala fingerprints are so similar to human ones that they've occasionally confused crime scene investigators.

Fact 2: Koalas sleep between 18 and 22 hours a day.

Fact 3: Their diet is almost entirely eucalyptus leaves, which are toxic to most other animals.

Weekly Wonder #85 — Platypuses

Clue: *This animal glows under UV light.*

Answer: Platypuses

Fact 1: Platypus fur glows a blue-green color under ultraviolet light, though scientists aren't fully sure why.

Fact 2: Male platypuses have venomous spurs on their hind legs.

Fact 3: They're one of the only mammals in the world that lay eggs instead of giving birth to live young.

Weekly Wonder #86 — Narwhals

Clue: *This animal's famous 'horn' is actually a giant tooth.*

Answer: Narwhals

Fact 1: A narwhal's tusk is really an overgrown canine tooth that can grow up to 3 metres long.

Fact 2: Usually only males grow the tusk, though some females can too.

Fact 3: The tusk is packed with nerve endings and is thought to help narwhals sense changes in their environment.

Weekly Wonder #87 — Peacocks

Clue: *Males of this bird lose their spectacular tail feathers every single year.*

Answer: Peacocks

Fact 1: Peacocks molt their long tail feathers after breeding season and grow a brand new set before the next one.

Fact 2: Only males have the famous colorful tail — females, called peahens, are much more plain.

Fact 3: A peacock's tail feathers can make up over 60% of its total body length.

Weekly Wonder #88 — Chameleons

Clue: *This animal doesn't mainly change color to hide from predators.*

Answer: Chameleons

Fact 1: Chameleons mostly change color to communicate mood or to help regulate their body temperature, not primarily for camouflage.

Fact 2: Their eyes can move independently, letting them look in two different directions at the same time.

Fact 3: A chameleon's tongue can shoot out faster than a Formula 1 car accelerates.

Weekly Wonder #89 — Boomerangs

Clue: *Some versions of this toy are designed to never come back.*

Answer: Boomerangs

Fact 1: Returning boomerangs are actually the exception — most boomerangs, historically used for hunting, were designed to fly straight and not return.

Fact 2: The curved shape of a returning boomerang works a bit like an airplane wing, creating lift as it spins through the air.

Fact 3: The oldest known boomerang is over 20,000 years old, found in a cave in Poland.

Weekly Wonder #90 — Fireworks

Clue: *The colors in this display come from burning different metals.*

Answer: Fireworks

Fact 1: Different metal compounds create different colors — strontium makes red, copper makes blue, and barium makes green.

Fact 2: Fireworks were invented in China over 1,000 years ago, originally as a way to scare off evil spirits.

Fact 3: Blue is the hardest firework color to create, since the copper compounds involved are especially unstable at high heat.

Weekly Wonder #91 — T-Rex

Clue: *This dinosaur had a bite force strong enough to crush a car.*

Answer: T-Rex

Fact 1: A T-Rex's bite force is estimated at up to 12,800 kgs — among the strongest of any land animal ever.

Fact 2: Despite its huge size, a T-Rex's arms were surprisingly short — only about the length of an adult human's arm.

Fact 3: Scientists believe young T-Rexes may have had feathers.

Weekly Wonder #92 — Penguins

Clue: *This bird proposes to its mate with a pebble.*

Answer: Penguins

Fact 1: Some penguin species, like Adelie penguins, offer a smooth pebble to a potential mate as a kind of proposal.

Fact 2: Penguins can't fly, but they 'fly' through water instead, reaching speeds of up to 35 km/h.

Fact 3: Emperor penguin dads keep their egg warm on their feet for around two months without eating, while the mothers hunt at sea.

Weekly Wonder #93 — Honey Bees

Clue: *This insect never sleeps.*

Answer: Honey Bees

Fact 1: Honey bees don't sleep the way humans do, but they do have rest periods where their antennae droop and they go still.

Fact 2: A single bee produces only about one twelfth of a teaspoon of honey in its entire lifetime.

Fact 3: Bees tell each other where to find food using a special 'waggle dance'.

Weekly Wonder #94 — Marshmallows

Clue: *This sweet treat was originally made from a plant root.*

Answer: Marshmallows

Fact 1: Marshmallows get their name from the marsh mallow plant, whose root sap was originally used to make the treat.

Fact 2: Ancient Egyptians were among the first to combine marsh mallow sap with honey to create an early version of the candy.

Fact 3: Modern marshmallows don't use the plant at all anymore — they're made mainly from sugar, corn syrup, and gelatin.

Weekly Wonder #95 — Bubble Wrap

Clue: *This packing material was originally invented as wallpaper.*

Answer: Bubble Wrap

Fact 1: Bubble wrap was invented in 1957 when two engineers tried to make textured wallpaper by sealing two shower curtains together.

Fact 2: After the wallpaper idea failed, they tried marketing it as greenhouse insulation before it finally caught on as packaging material.

Fact 3: There's an unofficial holiday called 'Bubble Wrap Appreciation Day', celebrated on the last Monday of January.

Weekly Wonder #96 — Rubik's Cube

Clue: *This puzzle has over 43 quintillion possible combinations.*

Answer: Rubik's Cube

Fact 1: A Rubik's Cube has roughly 43 quintillion possible arrangements — that's a 43 followed by 18 zeros.

Fact 2: It was invented in 1974 by a Hungarian professor, originally as a teaching tool to help explain 3D geometry.

Fact 3: The current world record for solving a Rubik's Cube is under 4 seconds.

Weekly Wonder #97 — Static Electricity

Clue: *This invisible force can make your hair stand straight up.*

Answer: Static Electricity

Fact 1: Static electricity happens when tiny charged particles called electrons build up on a surface and have nowhere to go.

Fact 2: Lightning is really just a giant, supercharged version of the same static shock you get from touching a doorknob.

Fact 3: Dry winter air makes static shocks more common, since moisture in the air normally helps the charge drain away harmlessly.

Weekly Wonder #98 — Quokkas

Clue: *This animal is often called the world's happiest animal because of its permanent smile.*

Answer: Quokkas

Fact 1: Quokkas are small marsupials native to Australia, and the shape of their face just naturally looks like a big smile.

Fact 2: They're famously unafraid of humans, which has made 'quokka selfies' a popular trend.

Fact 3: Quokkas are nocturnal and spend most of the day resting in shady spots.

Weekly Wonder #99 — Hiccups

Clue: *Babies do this while they're still inside the womb.*

Answer: Hiccups

Fact 1: Unborn babies can hiccup for minutes at a time, and scientists think it might help develop their breathing muscles.

Fact 2: The longest recorded case of hiccups in a person lasted 68 years.

Fact 3: Hiccups happen when your diaphragm suddenly contracts, and the ‘hic’ sound is your vocal cords snapping shut right after.

Weekly Wonder #100 — Fireflies

Clue: *This insect's light is nearly 100% efficient, wasting almost no energy as heat.*

Answer: Fireflies

Fact 1: A regular light bulb wastes most of its energy as heat, but a firefly's glow is almost entirely light — one of the most efficient light sources known.

Fact 2: Firefly light comes from a chemical reaction involving a compound called luciferin.

Fact 3: Each species of firefly has its own unique flashing pattern, which helps them recognize potential mates in the dark.
